

Facilitator Tips: Notes for All Sessions

These notes are tips the Facilitators found useful during the first iteration of the SI-MI Mentoring Course.

Zoom skills:

- Remind participants how to raise the zoom hand, as it is easier for facilitators to see
- Ask follow up questions for the comments in the chat, especially if the chat is active and the microphone is quiet. Questions such as:
 - Were you thinking of a particular example?
 - Has this strategy worked for you before?
 - Is there anything else you want to add?
- If a participant is difficult to understand due to connection issues, interrupt them and say “Hey, I am having issues to hear you, could you please turn off your camera and repeat? Or type your contribution in the chat?”
- It’s ok to pause for a moment if there is a particularly insightful comment before you continue
- Normalize multiple ways of participating: chat, voice, reactions

Tech and logistics:

- When sharing slides, be sure that the text size is big enough
- Be sure to take notes on participants attendance
- If you are short on time towards the end it is ok to not discuss the highlights of the session. The participants have been in the session so they know what they are. It is more important to spend time explaining what we need them to do for the next session (sign up, pre-work, etc)
- Have a backup plan for tech issues, such as slides accessible in a link in the chat and opening the session 5-10 minutes before it officially starts to be sure that everything is working

Language and communication:

- Be mindful of language that may be unintentionally harmful or exclusionary
- Avoid doing generalizations. It is better to speak from examples or patterns, not assumptions
- Acknowledge emotional or complex comments from participants
- Be mindful of using [ableist language](#). A resource to consider is the [Disability Language Guide from ASU](#) which includes recommendations on language that should be used
 - As an example, Dra. Nicole said in the feedback for session 6 in Fall 2025: *“Blind spot is an ableist term, because it denotes blindness or sight impairment to something negative, someone lacking knowledge or ignorant. It is better to be replaced with expressions such as ‘they have a weakness’, ‘have an area for growth’, ‘missed perspective’.*
- Check documents and resources for accessibility